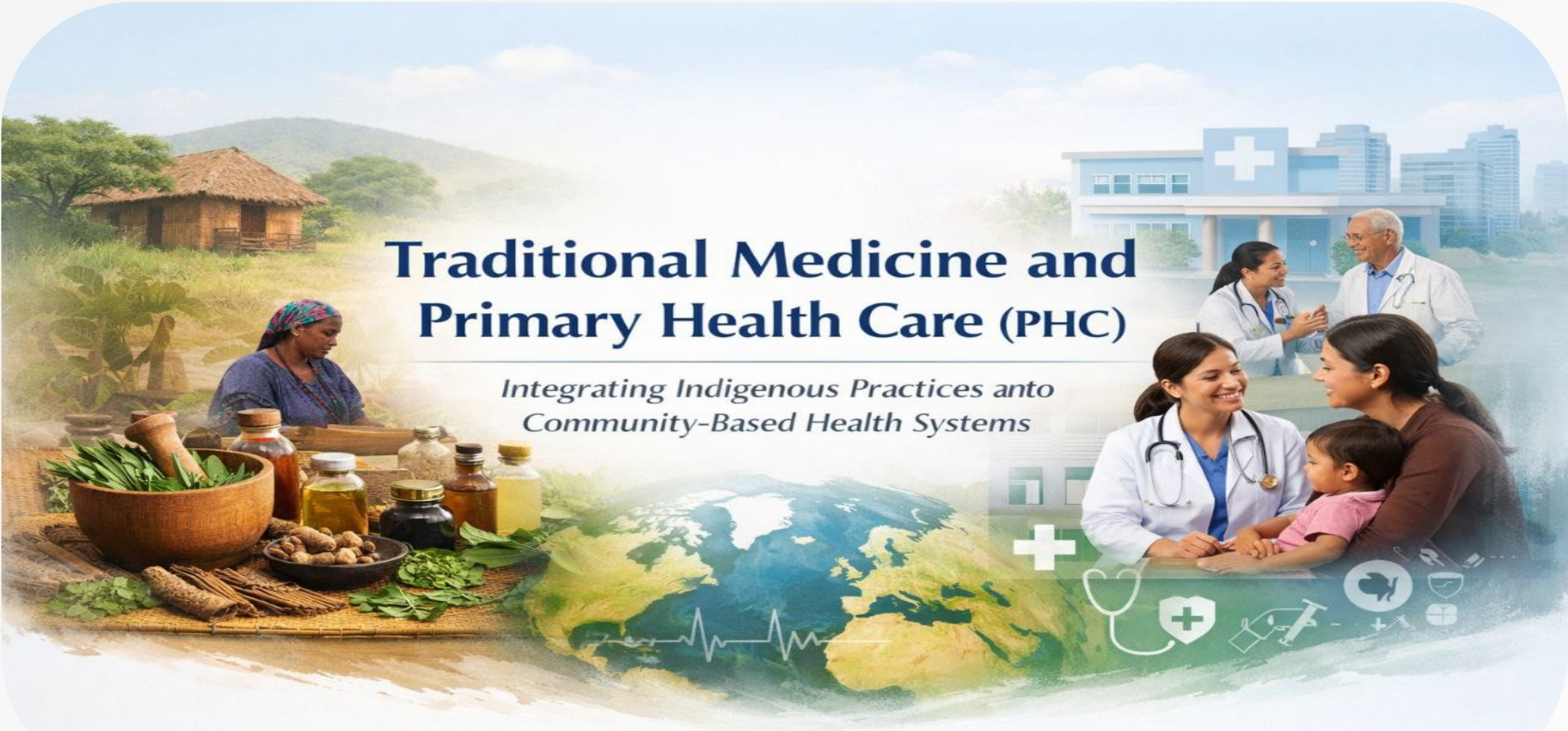




Traditional Medicine and Primary Health Care (PHC)

*Integrating Indigenous Practices into
Community-Based Health Systems*

Objectives

- Provide a brief overview of Primary Health Care (PHC)
- Explain methods of using traditional medicine within PHC services.
- Highlight the importance of training traditional medicine practitioners for safe integration into PHC.
- Discuss the advantages of using traditional medicine in Primary Health Care.

Brief Overview of Primary Health Care (PHC)

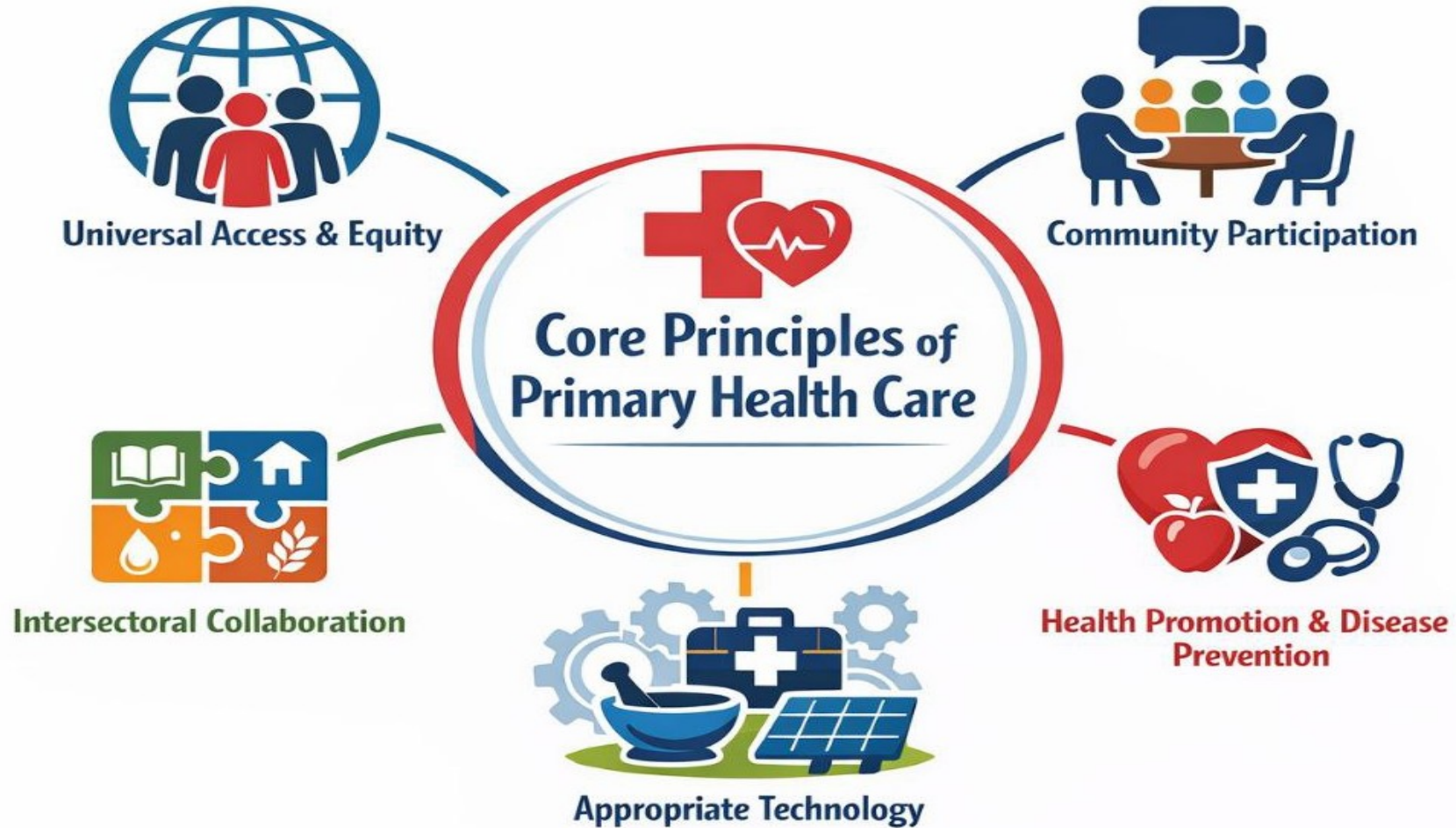


- ❖ First level of contact with the health system.
- ❖ Focuses on **prevention, promotion, treatment & rehabilitation.**
- ❖ Based on **equity, accessibility, affordability & community participation.**
- ❖ Strong PHC systems can address **up to 90% of health needs.**

Key facts(WHO)

- ❖ In 2022, more than 1.6 billion people faced poverty risks due to high out-of-pocket health spending. **10% of their household budget**
- ❖ primary health care in low- and middle-income countries could save 60 million lives and add 3.7 years to life expectancy by 2030.
- ❖ About 75% of Sustainable Development Goal health gains can be achieved through primary health care.
- ❖ Meeting PHC targets requires an additional annual investment of US\$ 200–328 billion.

PHC principles



Traditional Medicine

- ❖ Is a **holistic system** that promotes health through balance, harmony, natural healing, and prevention, based on **indigenous knowledge** developed over centuries.
- ❖ Includes **herbal medicines, manual therapies & spiritual healing**
- ❖ Often the **first choice of care** in rural areas



Methods of TM Integration into PHC



1. Clinical & Practice Integration

- ❖ Nutritional therapy & herbal remedies for common conditions
- ❖ Traditional midwives for maternal care
- ❖ Mental health support via elders/healers
- ❖ Massage, cupping, heat therapy for pain relief --**manual therapies**
- ❖ Collaborative care models with doctors & healers
- ❖ Evidence-based herbal use validated for safety
- ❖ Selected herbs with proven safety can be used at PHC level for:
 - Coughs and colds
 - Digestive issues
 - Skin infections and minor wounds

2. Policy & System Integration

- ❖ Laws for registering herbal medicines & licensing practitioners
- ❖ National ethnobotanical pharmacopoeia as reference
- ❖ Inclusion in medical training curricula
- ❖ Support for local herbal medicine production

3. Community & Cultural Integration

- ❖ Two-way referral between healers & PHC centers
- ❖ Educate communities: safe home remedies, avoid harmful practices
- ❖ Respect cultural & spiritual practices within PHC
- ❖ Incorporating acceptable cultural & spiritual counseling

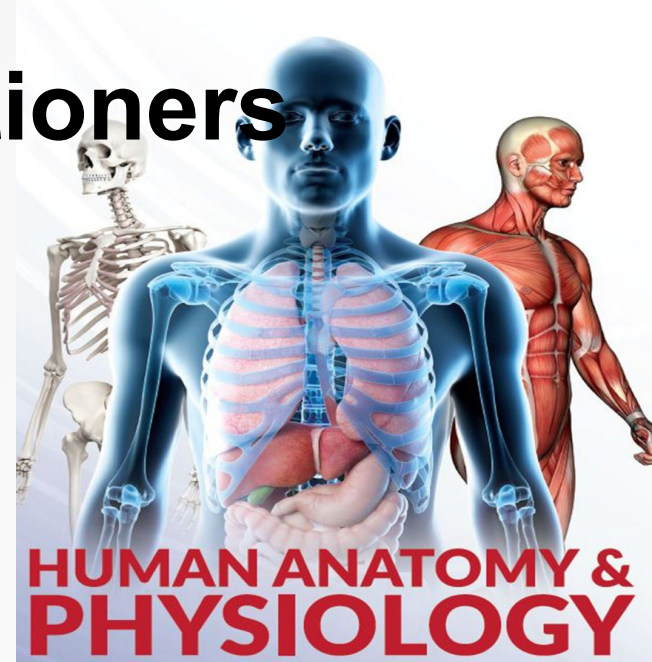
Training of Traditional Medicine Practitioners

Medical Basics

- ❖ Anatomy, physiology,
- ❖ Common Diseases and acute signs

Safe Practices

- ❖ Hygiene, sanitation, sterile tools
- ❖ Safe delivery methods
- ❖ Herbal medicine: correct plant ID, preparation, storage, dosage



Regulation & Quality

- ❖ Licensing & registration
- ❖ Standards for labeling, packaging, counterfeit prevention
- ❖ Pharmacovigilance: report adverse effects

Ethics & Professionalism

- Confidentiality, informed consent
- Respect & non-discrimination
- Truthful information, avoid false claims



Continuous Training

- Short courses & workshops
- Government regulation programs
- University collaborations for evidence-based practice

❑ *WHO emphasizes training for safety and quality.*



Experiences some countries in training



China

- ❖ +43 universities
- ❖ +170,000 students/year
- ❖ 5+3 years of study and practices
- ❖ As of 2021, China had over 621,000 licensed Traditional Chinese Medicine (TCM) doctors



India

- ❖ approximately 899 to 1,000+ total AYUSH medical colleges in India that train in traditional medicine practices.
- ❖ Under.g Over 59,000 seats per year
- ❖ (Postgraduate): 7,450 seats

Uses of Traditional Medicine in PHC

Enhanced Accessibility & Affordability

Geographic Reach & Cost-Effective



Cultural Acceptability & Trust

Embedded in Culture & Trusted Holistic Care



Holistic & Patient-Centered Care

Treats Root Causes & Whole Person



Reduced Burden on Health System

Less Strain on Clinics & Hospitals



Preventive & Health Promotion

Herbal Remedies & Health Education



Community Engagement & Support

Local Healers & Social Cohesion



Complementary with Modern Medicine

Integrates with Conventional Care

Barriers to Integration

- ❖ *Regulatory and Policy Gaps*
 - ❖ *Training and Knowledge Deficits*
 - ❖ *Cultural and Professional Resistance*
 - ❖ *Safety and Efficacy Concerns*
 - ❖ *Limited Evidence and Research*
 - ❖ Scarcity of scientific validation and integration models
- Resource Limitations***
- ❖ Inadequate funding

Real-Life Country Examples

Countries like **India, China, South Korea, Ghana, South Africa, Nepal, and Sri Lanka** actively use TM in PHC.

1.China – (TCM)

- (TCM) is part of national healthcare
- Used in hospitals and PHC clinics
- Includes:
 - Herbal medicine
 - Acupuncture
 - Tai Chi
- Doctors often combine **modern medicine + TCM**



2.India – AYUSH

India officially includes TM in PHC

- Systems used:
 - **Ayurveda**
 - **Yoga**
 - **Unani**
 - **Siddha**
 - **Homeopathy**
- Government supports it through **AYUSH health centers**
- Used for:Common illnesses
 - Preventive care
 - Lifestyle diseases



Ethiopian Context of TM Integration in PHC

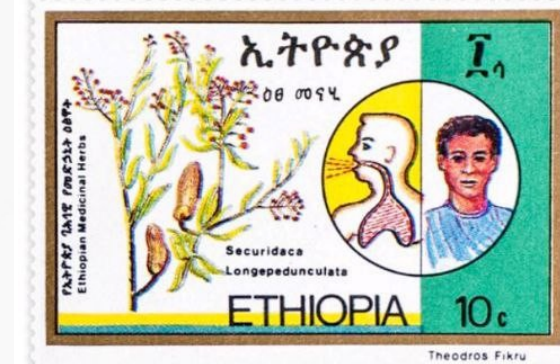
- Traditional medicine is widely used, especially in rural and remote areas.
- Includes
 - Herbal medicine
 - Spiritual healing
 - Bone setting
 - Traditional birth attendance
- The Ethiopian government recognizes TM as part of the national health system.
- The Health Sector Transformation Plan (HSTP) and National Drug Policy encourage safe use of TM.



- Ethiopian Public Health Institute (EPHI) support research on TM.
- TM is not fully integrated, but collaboration is increasing.

- **Challenges to Integration**

- Lack of scientific validation
- No standardized training or licensing system for healers safety, dosage, and quality control.
- Weak documentation and knowledge transfer.



Future Directions

- **For TM-PHC Integration in Ethiopia**
 - Establish a National Research Framework
 - Pilot Integrated Care Models
 - Strengthen Regulation & Quality Assurance
 - Expand Cross-Sectoral Training & Certification
 - Increase Investment in Institutional Capacity

Community-based Primary Healthcare

The key to unlocking health for all



Overall Impact

When safely integrated, traditional medicine strengthens PHC by increasing access, cultural acceptance, and continuity of care. Training and regulation ensure patient safety while allowing communities to benefit from both traditional and modern health systems.

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**THANK
YOU**